

National Digital Learning Policy — Implementation Guidelines

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These guidelines support institutions in implementing the National Digital Learning Policy (HEIRS/POL/2026/014). They translate the policy's principles into practical steps, from initial infrastructure assessment to LMS rollout, staff training, student onboarding and ongoing progress reporting.

1. Introduction

The guidelines are prepared for principals, directors, ICT coordinators and faculty who lead digital learning initiatives. They are comprehensive but intentionally modular: institutions may adopt components in a sequence that suits their context, provided the overall milestones set out in the annexure are met.

2. Applicability

These guidelines apply to all institutions covered by the policy. Institutions in the first year of implementation should follow the steps in this document in order; those that have already begun digital readiness work may audit against the steps and close identified gaps.

3. Implementation Steps

1. Conduct an infrastructure assessment of connectivity, hardware, power and software, and record the results in the readiness checklist.
2. Set up an LMS, choosing an accessible platform with course, assessment and communication features, and train at least two system administrators.
3. Map the core curriculum to identify the courses most suitable for blended delivery in the first year.
4. Run a structured faculty digital capacity programme, with certification and a completion record for every participant.
5. Create or curate digital content for priority courses, starting with the Blended Learning Kit templates supplied by the department.
6. Onboard students to the LMS with orientation sessions covering platform use, academic integrity and help channels.

7. Implement accessibility requirements, including captions on new video content and alternate formats for core materials.
8. Adopt the baseline cybersecurity practices, including account management, regular backups and an incident reporting procedure.
9. Publish an institutional digital learning implementation timeline with quarterly milestones and named owners.
10. Start progress reporting through the annual readiness self-assessment and the quarterly implementation brief.

4. Institutional Responsibilities

- Appoint a Digital Learning Coordinator as a single point of contact for the Department.
- Establish a Digital Learning Implementation Committee with faculty, student and IT representation.
- Ensure the budget, procurement and staffing needed for the first-year milestones.
- Communicate the policy and guidelines to all faculty and students.
- Keep complete records of training, content and infrastructure investments.

5. Operational Guidelines

5.1 Infrastructure Assessment

Assess: bandwidth and network reliability; ratio of workstations to students and their working condition; availability of projectors, speakers and microphones in classrooms; power backup; and the state of the device lending library. Priorities are derived directly from the readiness checklist in the annexure.

5.2 LMS Setup

Configure the LMS with institutional roles, one course shell per active course, a consistent course template and a public-facing course catalogue. Test the platform on the devices most common among students before rollout and prepare a short troubleshooting guide for common issues.

5.3 Staff Training

Training must be hands-on and relevant to local teaching realities. Use a taught, workshop-style format covering the core skills listed in the policy. Issue certificates of completion and maintain records that can be audited. Appoint faculty champions who can provide peer mentoring after the formal training ends.

5.4 Digital Content Creation

Content should follow the universal design principles in the annexure: short segments, clearly stated learning outcomes, structured slides, accessible formats and a mix of reading, video and assessment. Institutions should reuse and adapt open educational resources before commissioning new content.

5.5 Student Onboarding

Conduct onboarding in the first two weeks of the semester. Cover account activation, navigation, communication norms, academic integrity rules, accessibility options and how to reach the helpdesk. Provide a companion guide in the course catalogue.

5.6 Accessibility Requirements

All new multimedia must include captions and transcripts; documents must be structured with real headings rather than formatting alone; and the LMS must support keyboard navigation. Institutions must maintain an accessibility log recording audits and remedial actions.

5.7 Cybersecurity Practices

Adopt strong password or passkey policies, enable multi-factor authentication where available, perform scheduled data backups, restrict admin rights, and maintain an incident log. Mandatory annual cybersecurity awareness training applies to all staff.

6. Reporting Requirements

Institutions submit: (i) an annual Digital Readiness Self-Assessment; (ii) a quarterly implementation brief covering milestones, training completions, infrastructure improvements and challenges; and (iii) an end-of-year summary feeding the national monitoring dashboard.

7. Compliance and Review

Non-compliance may affect access to department digital-learning grants and capacity-building support. Institutions at risk should contact the Digital Learning Division early to agree a support plan. These guidelines themselves will be reviewed alongside the parent policy and updated as good practice evolves.

8. Contact and Support Note

Institutions may contact the Digital Learning Division of the Higher Education Department through the HEIRS portal with questions about this policy and guidelines. A national support desk, peer-learning webinars and a repository of approved toolkits are available to help institutions implement these steps effectively.